

EGOR ZAKHAROV

Staff Research Scientist · Meta Reality Labs · Pittsburgh, PA

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Expertise: neural head avatars, strand-based hair reconstruction, and human-centric 4D reconstruction.

EXPERIENCE

Meta Reality Labs

Staff Research Scientist

Senior Research Scientist

Pittsburgh, United States

Aug 2026 – present

Feb 2025 – Jul 2026

- Tech lead of a five-person research pod working on human-centric 4D reconstruction.
- The pod's depth-estimation and body-fitting models run in Meta's production data and training pipelines.

ETH Zürich — AIT Lab (Prof. Otmar Hilliges)

Postdoctoral Researcher

Zürich, Switzerland

Jul 2023 – Feb 2025

- Strand-based hair reconstruction and generation.
- Collaborations on one-shot 3D head reenactment for VR telepresence.
- Day-to-day technical supervision of two PhD students.

Samsung AI Center

Lead Research Scientist (formal title: Lead Engineer)

Research Scientist (formal title: Engineer)

Moscow, Russia

Mar 2020 – Jun 2023

Sep 2018 – Feb 2020

- Led a team focused on neural head avatars and telepresence; hired and mentored its researchers.

EDUCATION

Skolkovo Institute of Science and Technology (Skoltech)

PhD, Computational and Data Science and Engineering (advisor: Prof. Victor Lempitsky)

MS, Data Science

Moscow, Russia

Nov 2018 – Apr 2023

2016 – 2018

Lomonosov Moscow State University (MSU)

BS, Applied Mathematics and Computer Science

Moscow, Russia

2011 – 2016

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- GenLCA: 3D Diffusion for Full-Body Avatars from In-the-Wild Videos — ECCV 2026 · *spotlight*
Y. Wu, R. Khrodgar, E. Zakharov, T. Bagautdinov, L. Xiao, Z. Su, S. Saito, X. Jin, J. Li
- GeoRelight: Learning Joint Geometrical Relighting and Reconstruction ... — CVPR 2026 · *highlight, top 3.6%*
Y. Xue, R. Liang, E. Zakharov, T. Bagautdinov, C. Cao, G. Nam, S. Saito, G. Pons-Moll, J. Romero
- Realiz3D: 3D Generation Made Photorealistic via Domain-Aware Learning — CVPR 2026
I. Sobol, K. Sohn, Y. Blum, E. Zakharov, M. Bluvstein, A. Vedaldi, O. Litany
- Large-scale Codec Avatars: The Unreasonable Effectiveness of Large-scale Avatar Pretraining — CVPR 2026
J. Li, R. Khrodgar, C. He, ..., E. Zakharov, ..., S. Saito
- Im2Haircut: Single-view Strand-based Hair Reconstruction for Human Avatars — ICCV 2025
V. Sklyarova, E. Zakharov, M. Prinzer, G. Becherini, M. J. Black, J. Thies
- Human Hair Reconstruction with Strand-Aligned 3D Gaussians — ECCV 2024
E. Zakharov, V. Sklyarova, M. J. Black, G. Nam, J. Thies, O. Hilliges
- HAAR: Text-Conditioned Generative Model of 3D Strand-based Human Hairstyles — CVPR 2024
V. Sklyarova, E. Zakharov, O. Hilliges, M. J. Black, J. Thies
- VODOO XP: Expressive One-Shot Head Reenactment for VR Telepresence — ACM TOG (SIGGRAPH Asia) 2024
P. Tran, E. Zakharov, L. N. Ho, L. Hu, ..., A. T. Tran, H. Li
- VODOO VR: One-Shot Neural Avatars for Virtual Reality — SIGGRAPH 2024 · *Real-Time Live! demo*
P. Tran, E. Zakharov, L. N. Ho, A. Karmanov, M. Kengeskanov, ..., O. Hilliges, H. Li
- Neural Haircut: Prior-Guided Strand-Based Hair Reconstruction — ICCV 2023 · *oral, top 1.8%*
V. Sklyarova, J. Chelishchev, I. Medvedev, A. Dogaru, V. Lempitsky, E. Zakharov
- MegaPortraits: One-shot Megapixel Neural Head Avatars — ACM MM 2022
N. Drobyshev, J. Chelishchev, T. Khakhulin, A. Ivakhnenko, V. Lempitsky, E. Zakharov
- Realistic One-shot Mesh-based Head Avatars (ROME) — ECCV 2022
T. Khakhulin, V. Sklyarova, V. Lempitsky, E. Zakharov
- Fast Bi-layer Neural Synthesis of One-Shot Realistic Head Avatars — ECCV 2020
E. Zakharov, A. Ivakhnenko, A. Shysheya, V. Lempitsky
- Few-Shot Adversarial Learning of Realistic Neural Talking Head Models — ICCV 2019 · *oral, top 4.6%*
E. Zakharov, A. Shysheya, E. Burkov, V. Lempitsky

SERVICE & HONORS

- Reviewer for CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, NeurIPS, and ICLR (2019 – present).
- Samsung Best Paper Award, Silver (2019) · #1 in the Altmetric Top 100 (2019).